

Xiaomi Pad 8

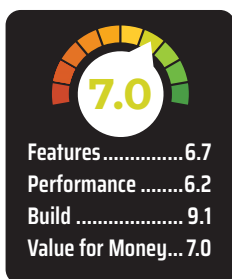
If it ain't broke, make it thinner

₹35,999



Android tablets, long treated as inadequate alternatives to the iPad, have matured considerably. In the first three months of 2026, the market has witnessed a 5% growth in comparison to 2025 even though the prices increased due to prevailing memory shortage, according to Counterpoint Research. The premium end is particularly active with tablets priced above Rs 20,000 recording a 71% surge in Q3 2025 and 11-inch devices accounting for 59% of all tablet sales. The Xiaomi Pad 7 captured 36% of premium tablet sales in Q1 2025, per CMR's India Tablet PC Market Leaderboard. Xiaomi has played a crucial role in offering the right features-to-price ratio for buyers who want a serious Android tablet without crossing into iPad price territory. This year, the Xiaomi Pad 8 builds on that with some focused upgrades.

Place the Pad 7 (review) and Pad 8 side by side and you will not be able



to discern the differences because Xiaomi isn't here to fix what's not broken. The Pad 8 has a slimmer, lighter chassis that houses a larger 9,200 mAh battery. The Snapdragon 7+ Gen 3 on the Pad 7 gives way to the Snapdragon 8s Gen 4 on the Pad 8 and HyperOS 3 ships out of the box on Android 16. The Focus Pen Pro has been redesigned from the ground up, replacing physical buttons with a haptics-based gesture system. After extended daily use as a media device and a portable work machine, the Pad 8 is an easy recommendation for the right buyer.

XIAOMI PAD 8 REVIEW: DESIGN AND DISPLAY

At 5.75 mm and 485 g, the Pad 8 is thinner and lighter than its predecessor. The flat-edge aluminium design retains the premium feel of the Pad 7 and the reduced weight is immediately apparent in hand. This is a tablet comfortable enough for extended reading sessions or

for propping up on the kitchen counter while following a recipe, without the fatigue that heavier slates bring with sustained use.

The 11.2-inch LCD panel carries over from the Pad 7. In our testing using the Portrait Displays' Calman colour calibration tool, the display achieves a Delta E of 2.4 and covers 98.9% of the sRGB colour space. The brightness reaches 779 nits in manual mode and exceeds 1,000 nits in adaptive mode, which holds up well outdoors. The 3:2 aspect ratio continues to earn its keep: the additional vertical space benefits split-screen tasks and document reading that a wider 16:10 panel would not provide. At a maximum of 144 Hz, scrolling and animations are fluid throughout. In addition, a nano-texture variant is available at a premium for users who frequently work in high-glare environments.

XIAOMI PAD 8 REVIEW: PERFORMANCE

The Snapdragon 8s Gen 4, built on TSMC's 4 nm process, is a significant step up from the Pad 7's Snapdragon 7+ Gen 3. The Pad 8 scores approximately 2.4m in AnTuTu and the gains translate into real-world use: demanding games run well, multitasking is smooth and sustained workloads do not cause thermal issues on a device with this surface area.

HyperOS 3 on Android 16 brings meaningful refinements to the software experience. The UI and apps now feel naturally befitting of the larger screen estate rather than being retrofitted, however, some UI inconsistencies such as the File Manager app opening in portrait mode even if the tablet orientation is in landscape make it fall short of being called a perfect experience. The floating windows and a workstation mode supporting up to four simultaneous apps are well implemented. The AI suite, which covers AI Writing, AI Live Subtitles via Meeting Toolbox 4.0 and AI Recorder with transcription, provides practical tools for productivity users. Xiaomi's cross-device intercon-